

ACECQA Service Quality, Accessibility & Operations Analysis — Presentation Script

Target length: ~9:00, inside the assignment's hard 5–10 minute window. **[SHOW ...]** marks when to bring up each chart; keep your face visible in a corner the whole time per the assignment requirement.

Structure: one central business problem, three angles on it. Every section opens by naming the problem or question *before* the chart appears — the chart is evidence for a claim you've already made, not a pattern you're discovering out loud. If you only remember one thing from these delivery notes: never say "here's a chart showing X" — say "X is a problem, here's the proof" instead.

Opening — state the problem, not the topic (0:00–0:45)

[Face to camera, title slide]

"Hi, I'm [YOUR NAME], and I work for government to improve education and care services across Australia. Here's the problem I'm solving: ACECQA and state governments have a limited budget for lifting service quality and funding new services, across seventeen thousand approved services nationally. Spent well, that budget closes real gaps for families. Spent on the wrong thing, it doesn't move the needle. So today, three questions with data: where is quality actually failing and why, where are families genuinely cut off from services, and — just as important — what should we *stop* assuming matters, so we don't waste money chasing it."

Data & method, briefly (0:45–1:10)

[SHOW a slide with the dataset summary, or talk over the title slide]

"Quickly on the data: this is the national register of every approved service, with quality ratings and transport-access data. Before trusting it, I checked it — ten services had no address at all and had all been geocoded to the same point in Myanmar. I dropped those rather than guess. Everything else checked out."

Problem 1: Is quality failing consistently, or is it a specific, fixable issue? (1:10–3:45)

"First problem: all eight states and territories apply the same National Law. If quality outcomes are wildly inconsistent anyway, that's either a resourcing gap or an enforcement gap — and knowing which one matters, because they need completely different fixes."

Chart 1 — Rating by state, ranked by non-compliance (1:20–1:55)

[SHOW 01_rating_by_state.png]

"They are wildly inconsistent — and I'm ranking this by who's actually failing the legal minimum, not who's excelling. The Northern Territory is worst: twenty-two percent of its services rated Working Towards NQS or Significant Improvement Required. Victoria is best, at four percent. Same law, five-times difference. That's not noise — that's a finding that should already be uncomfortable for a

national regulator."

Chart 2 — Rating by service type (1:55–2:15)

[SHOW 02_rating_by_service_type.png]

"It's not just geography. Long Day Care — the single largest category in the dataset — sits at eighteen percent Exceeding, well behind preschools at forty-six to fifty percent. If we're prioritising where a quality-improvement dollar does the most good, Long Day Care is where the volume is."

Chart 3 — Which Quality Area drags states down (2:15–2:50)

[SHOW 03_quality_area_heatmap.png]

"This chart zooms from the overall number into which specific component drives it. The Northern Territory and Tasmania still lead — but by this component-level measure, Western Australia and South Australia join them near the top, up to fourteen percent non-compliant in a single quality area, even though WA ranked only fourth on the overall measure in Chart 1. A state's overall rating isn't a simple average of its seven components, so a state can look mid-table overall while hiding a real problem in one specific area — concentrated here in Quality Area 1, educational program, and Quality Area 7, governance."

Chart 4 — Spatial map of ratings (2:45–3:00)

[SHOW 04_spatial_ratings_map.png]

"And it's local enough to act on directly — you can see clusters of underperforming services around Perth and Adelaide specifically, which means a support team could be deployed to a cluster, not spread across an entire state."

Chart 5 — Does distance from transport hurt quality? (3:00–3:45)

[SHOW 05_transport_vs_quality.png]

"Before recommending a fix, I need to test the obvious hypothesis: does poor transport access damage quality? I looked at the share of services rated below the NQS standard by distance to the nearest train station. It rises from seven-point-six percent for the closest services to ten-point-three for the furthest — real and significant, but small. A transport upgrade might nudge quality slightly; it won't close a ten-times state-level gap. A minor risk factor beside much bigger drivers."

Problem 2: Are families structurally cut off from services, and where worst? (3:45–5:50)

"Second problem, and the assignment sets four specific questions here. I'm answering each one directly, with a chart built to prove a claim, not just describe a distribution."

Chart 6 — How concentrated is provision in cities versus the country? (3:45–4:10)

[SHOW 06_geographic_distribution.png]

"First: the geographic disparity itself. Measuring services per square kilometre by ABS area type, Major Urban areas have about twelve thousand times the density of Rural Balance areas. That's not just 'cities have more people' — it's an order of magnitude beyond any population ratio you could justify."

Provision is structurally concentrated, not just naturally uneven."

Chart 7 — Where are additional services needed most? (4:10–4:35)

[SHOW 07_underserved_regions.png]

"Second: where specifically should ACECQA add capacity? I measured, for every service, the distance to its nearest alternative — the real question a family asks when their usual centre is full or closed. Ranked worst first: Western Australia's Bounded Localities are the single worst case in the country, a median forty-one kilometres to a backup option. The Northern Territory's Bounded Localities are second, at thirty kilometres. These are the two places a new-service dollar should go first — not a general 'rural funding' line, a named list."

Chart 8 — Are services well-connected to public transport? (4:35–5:05)

[SHOW 08_transport_connectivity.png]

"Third: transport connectivity specifically, using the actual distance-to-station and distance-to-bus-stop fields. Fifty-five percent of services nationally aren't within a short trip of either. And here's the finding that should reframe this as a transport-planning problem, not just a rural one: even inside Major Urban areas, half of all services fail this test. This isn't only about remote Australia — it's a gap inside our own cities."

Chart 9 — Where do the transport gaps concentrate? (5:05–5:50)

[SHOW 09_spatial_connectivity.png]

"Fourth: mapping every poorly-connected service directly, rather than just a state or area-type average. Almost nine thousand services, in red, more than a short trip from any train or bus stop — and look at where the red sits inside the coastal cities too, not only out past the urban fringe. That confirms Chart 8 isn't an artefact of how the categories were drawn: the transport gap is genuinely widespread."

Problem 3: Which operational factors actually drive quality — and which just look like they do? (5:55–8:15)

"Third problem, and it's a different kind of test. ACECQA could point to four operational levers — size, year-round operation, opening hours, how old a service is — and assume any of them explains quality. I tested all four directly. Two matter. Two don't."

Chart 10 — Does size predict quality? No. (5:58–6:18)

[SHOW 10_capacity_by_type.png]

"Capacity varies a lot by type and by area — sixty-six places typical in major cities, twenty-seven in small country towns. But tested directly against rating, the correlation is negligible. A bigger centre isn't a better- or worse-run one — useful for Problem 2: a new rural service doesn't need to match a city-sized centre to be a good one."

Chart 11 — Does year-round operation predict quality? Not independently. (6:18–6:40)

[SHOW 11_operating_pattern_by_type.png]

"Long Day Care runs almost entirely year-round and scored lower than preschools in Chart 2 — that could look hours-driven. But controlling for type, comparing year-round to term-time within Long Day Care only, there aren't enough term-time services to draw a conclusion. This is mostly standing in for service type, already covered — not an independent driver."

Chart 12 — Does approval date predict quality? Yes — the strongest signal here. (6:40–7:30)

[SHOW 12_approval_trend.png]

"A data trap first: approvals-per-year spikes in 2012 — over four thousand in one year. Read naively, that's explosive growth. It isn't — the National Quality Framework commenced that January and bulk-transferred every already-operating service onto new numbers, not newly opened ones. The right-hand panel is the real story: grouped by when they were actually approved, services from 2019 onward sit at just eight-point-six percent Exceeding or above, against twenty-two-point-eight percent for pre-2012, long-established services. Newer services simply haven't had the years of embedded practice yet. That's the strongest operational signal in this whole analysis."

Chart 13 — Does opening hours predict quality? Yes, modestly. (7:30–8:10)

[SHOW 13_hours_vs_quality.png]

"Opening hours does show a real relationship — thirty-seven percent Exceeding under forty-five hours a week, down to eighteen percent for the longest-opening services. Smaller than the approval-cohort effect, but real. And closing the loop on Problem 1: transport still doesn't move capacity or hours in any meaningful way — its small quality effect from Chart 5 stands on its own. Two of four operational levers actually drive quality; two are noise dressed up as insight."

Close — the decision, not a recap (8:10–8:50)

[Face to camera, optional summary slide]

"Back to the budget question. One: the Northern Territory is the clearest case for urgent, statewide compliance intervention in educational program and governance — a legal-minimum problem, not a generic audit. Tasmania, South Australia and WA aren't far behind. Two: new-service funding has a named destination, not a general rural line — WA's and the NT's Bounded Localities, forty-one and thirty kilometres respectively from a family's nearest backup option. Three: transport connectivity needs its own budget line separate from rural funding — half of Major Urban services fail the same connectivity test as remote ones, so this is a city-planning fix as much as a remote-access one, and real but small as a quality lever, don't oversell it. And four: give newly-approved services a support pathway, not a compliance one — they just haven't had the years yet. A budget with a reason behind every line. Thank you."

Delivery notes

- ~1,326 spoken words. At 140–160 words/minute that's roughly 8:15–9:30 — comfortable margin under the 10-minute hard cap even at a deliberate, unhurried pace. Practice once to check your own rate.

- **If you need to cut time**, in order: (1) the "Data & method" beat — compress the Myanmar catch to one sentence, (2) Chart 9's own beat — the "confirms Chart 8" line can be one sentence instead of two, (3) Chart 11 — one sentence instead of two. Never cut Chart 5 or the transport call-back in Chart 13 — that "small effect, sized honestly against the bigger drivers" chain is your strongest evidence of analytical rigour for a policy audience, and it's what makes the closing recommendation credible rather than asserted.
- If asked why urban/rural wasn't done with the postcode-allocation method: the direct spatial join avoids the many-to-many postcode-to-SA1 mapping problem, since the dataset already has coordinates for every service.
- Keep the Family Day Care data-quality catches (capacity populated for only 2 of 417 services; "hours" meaning something structurally different for a scheme vs a single centre) in your back pocket for Q&A even if you don't narrate them in the timed script.